

Calmasutra

Women have a knack of keeping their sexuality a secret

By Prasad Bidapa

Whoever said that India was a nation of prudes needs to go through the INFLUENCE-NIELSEN ORG. (NIO) sex survey to realise that the modern woman's sexuality is now almost completely released from the Victorian prudery that dogged the post-Independence generation. Women now figure that they can do just anything they want, out of bed or in it. Sex in the city is curiously liberated, and if you thought you knew what women were thinking, you probably got it wrong.

In Ahmedabad, lesbians are out of the closet; in Lucknow, they fantasise most about girl-on-girl action. Male prostitutes are popular with the

ladies of Ludhiana while Chennai maams think nothing of indulging in underage sex. In Patna, adultery gets a high approval rating, and Bangalore goes Wild with wife-swapping when the batteries in their sex toys run out. Kinky sex in Kolkata, sex with eunuchs in Chennai. Anal sex? *Agga wokay!* Sado-masochism? *Saru che!* Pornography? *Zindabad!* And of course incest is best.

But Indian women seem to have had a figurative *ghunghat* firmly in place when it comes to answering personal questions. Much to everyone's chagrin, most do not admit to ever having had a sexual fantasy. Yeah, right. I then decided to con-

Which celebrity would you like to have sex with?

Males

Aishwarya Rai (6)
Katrina Kaif (6)
Kareena Kapoor (4)

Females

Salman Khan (2)
Shah Rukh Khan (2)
M.S. Dhoni (1)

All figures in per cent

Have you ever tried any of the following?

		Male	Female
Anal sex	29	29	29
Bisexual sex	20	25	14
Group sex	9	13	3
Homosexual sex	6	8	4
Sex with animals	1	1	0
Sex with children	1	2	1
Sado-masochism	15	20	10
None	47	41	64

For 3,923 respondents of the total of 5,353 who have had sex. Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices. All figures in per cent

improper based on whatever societal or community norms they're imposing on the people they're trying to repress. So is BDSM sex in India a result of a genuine, evolved need for kinky sex, or is it merely a cultural import, couples dressing up and playing because it's fun, or because they saw it in a film, or in porn, and thought it was cool? If the latter, does this qualify as being kinky, or merely imitative?

What is kinky and made in India? On the basis of casual interviews and this survey, I'd say the SMS phenomenon; homemade porn for the world to see, a definite statement about breaking taboos, being exhibitionists in a country where kissing in films still makes news. One in five Hyderabad porn-watching men has already starred in his own porn video, and one in three Bangalorean porn aficionado wants to make one. In this desire they are ably supported by Bangalorean women—one in four female Bangalorean porn-watchers has starred in a